

BRIEF-ALIGNED EXECUTIVE REPORT

Strategic Environment Mapping: executive readout

Prepared report / 14 Jun 2026

PRIMARY ANSWER

The strategic environment around Yousician is broader than direct competitors: music learning, hobby discovery, AI, songs, hardware, creators, education, rights, investors, media, awards and funding all shape the market.

96 tracked records

28 key players

49 news-grade moves

12 brief categories

3 guiding questions answered

This report follows the requested structure: ecosystem map, key players, database, relationship fields, guiding answers and last-24-month market moves. Appfigures and internal relationship inputs remain explicit completion layers.

Direct answers to the guiding questions

The three guiding questions are answered before any supporting detail.

Who influences the future of music learning? Who is successful?

Learning is shaped by direct apps, song/practice systems, AI practice utilities, teacher/creator educators, education benchmarks and hardware funnels. Success is clearest by type: Simply for direct-app benchmarking, Ultimate Guitar for repertoire, Moises for AI practice utility, Suno for AI creation, BandLab/Splice for hobby creation, ABRSM/Trinity/School of Rock for trust, and Fender/Gibson/Yamaha for hardware funnels.

Who influences music as a hobby?

TikTok, YouTube, Spotify, creator tools, tabs and notation, artists, cultural moments, instrument brands, retailers, and AI generation tools.

Who shapes the strategic environment?

AI companies, rights owners, app-based learning competitors, hardware brands, creator platforms, publishers, investors, funding bodies, awards, media, and education benchmarks.

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Priority actors and success surfaces

Top actors first; success is shown by influence surface, not by unvalidated app-performance ranking.

01

Simply

Learning apps / Yousician + GuitarTuna

Useful benchmark for onboarding, motivation, pricing, and growth in app-based music education.

Credentialed data pending

02

Ultimate Guitar

Practice habits / GuitarTuna

Strong influence on how hobbyists discover songs and move from inspiration to practice.

Credentialed data pending

03

Moises

AI music tech / Yousician + GuitarTuna

Strong example of AI improving practice workflows without replacing instrument learning.

Source-backed profile

04

Suno

AI music tech / GuitarTuna

May shift the meaning of music participation, motivation, and creation for casual users.

Source-backed profile

05

BandLab

Creation tools / Broader ecosystem

Represents the shift from learning an instrument to making and sharing music quickly.

Relationship field open

06

Fender

Gear channels / GuitarTuna

Instrument brands can shape the beginner funnel before users choose a learning app.

Relationship field open

07

YouTube

Practice habits / Yousician + GuitarTuna

A major substitute and funnel for self-guided learning; it shapes inspiration, discovery, and expectations of free content.

Source-backed profile

08

Spotify for Artists

Market signals / Broader ecosystem

Important for how hobbyists understand music success, release goals, artist identity, and AI-authenticity debates.

Relationship field open

09

TikTok for Artists

Market signals / GuitarTuna

TikTok can shape song discovery, cultural momentum, and what learners want to play.

Relationship field open

10

Duolingo

Education benchmarks / Yousician

Not music-specific, but highly relevant for learning loops, retention, brand, and AI in education.

Source-backed profile

These actors are shown first because they best answer the brief's core questions: learning influence, hobby influence, success surfaces, and strategic environment pressure.



Directly App / JoyTunes

Closest benchmark for onboarding, motivation, subscription learning and beginner conversion.

Appfigures still required for performance ranking.

REPertoire / Practice Surface
URinate Guitar / Muse Group

Strong song-intent and repertoire ownership around tabs, chords and practice habits.

AI Practice Utility
Music.AI / Moises

Stems, isolation, transcription and creator-practice workflows connect AI to actual playing.

AI Creation Signal
Suno

Funding, rights debate and product visibility make AI music creation a market-structure force.

Hobby Creation / Community
BandLab / Splice

Creator workflows and communities shape participation beyond formal learning.

Trust Curriculum
ABRSM / Trinity / School of Rock

Certification, teacher trust and education infrastructure shape confidence.

Hardcore Funnel
Fender / Gibson / Yamaha

Brands and retailers influence instrument access, bundles and beginner pathways.

All 28 key players at a glance

Every key player is visible without turning the first-read export into a long database appendix.

Learning apps

9 key players

Simply / Fretello / Gibson App / Musora / Pickup Music / Rocksmith+ / Fender Play / Flowkey / Guitar Tricks

Direct music-learning products, curricula, feedback loops, and subscription benchmarks.

Practice habits

5 key players

YouTube / Chord ai / Ultimate Guitar / Chordify / JustinGuitar

Song discovery, tabs, play-along utilities, creators, and repeat-practice habits.

Gear channels

4 key players

Positive Grid / Fender / Gibson / Yamaha

Instrument brands and retailers that shape gear access, beginner bundles, and partner routes.

Creation tools

3 key players

BandLab / Splice / FL Studio

Tools that move people from learning and practice into making, arranging, producing, and sharing.

AI music tech

4 key players

Suno / Moises / ElevenLabs Music / Udio

AI-native generation, audio utilities, practice augmentation, and licensing/rights shifts.

Education benchmarks

1 key player

Duolingo

Non-music learning products, formal music education, teacher networks, and pedagogy references.

Market signals

2 key players

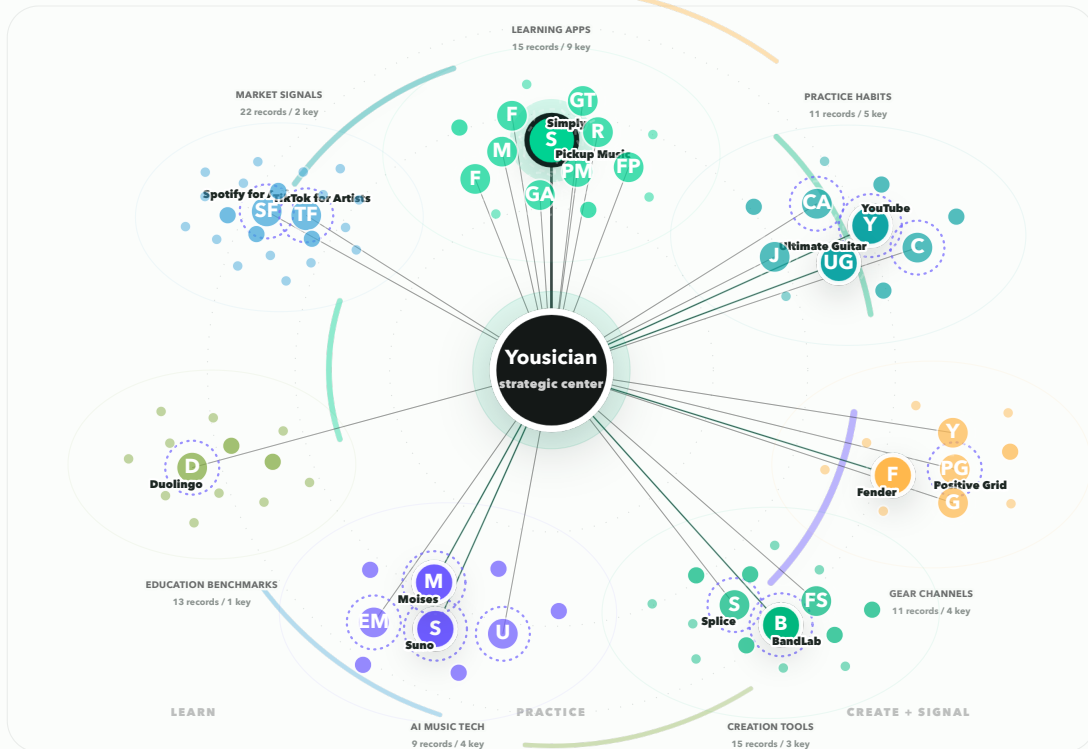
Spotify for Artists / TikTok for Artists

Investors, news, awards, funding programmes, and external indicators to monitor.

Detailed one-player evidence remains in the full appendix and workbook. The first-read version keeps all 28 key players visible without turning the executive report into a database dump.

Ecosystem map and category coverage

Visual map plus the requested brief categories.



Learning apps

15 records / 9 key players
Simply, Pickup Music,
Rocksmith+

Practice habits

11 records / 5 key players
YouTube, Chord ai, Ultimate
Guitar

Gear channels

11 records / 4 key players
Positive Grid, Fender, Yamaha

Creation tools

15 records / 3 key players
BandLab, Splice, FL Studio

AI music tech

9 records / 4 key players
Suno, Moises, Udio

Education benchmarks

13 records / 1 key players
Duolingo, ABRSM, Kahoot

Market signals

22 records / 2 key players
Spotify for Artists, TikTok for
Artists, MIDiA Research

Brief category coverage

The requested categories are shown individually, not collapsed into broad buckets.

Music learning apps and platforms

COVERED

Simply, Flowkey, Skoove, Fender Play, Gibson App, Rocksmith+ and related app benchmarks.

Instrument brands, manufacturers and distributors

COVERED

Fender, Gibson, Yamaha, Positive Grid, retailers and beginner hardware funnels.

Teachers, schools and music education organizations

COVERED

ABRSM, Trinity, RSL/Rockschool, School of Rock, Berklee Online and teacher networks.

Music hobby software ecosystem

COVERED

Ultimate Guitar, MuseScore, Songsterr, BandLab, Splice and creation/practice tools.

Wider education and self-improvement ecosystem

COVERED

Duolingo, online learning platforms and education benchmarks are represented.

Investors active in the space

COVERED

VC, growth, strategic and corporate capital signals are included.

Influencers, creators and educators

COVERED

Creator educators are treated as trust and demand-shaping actors.

Media, publishers and cultural drivers

COVERED

TikTok, YouTube, Spotify, specialist media and cultural moments are mapped.

AI companies and AI initiatives

COVERED

Suno, Music.AI/Moises, Udio, ElevenLabs and rights infrastructure are visible.

Awards

COVERED

Award opportunities are tracked separately from funding.

Funding

COVERED

Public, EU/Finnish and innovation funding options are tracked separately from investors.

Last 24 months on the market

COVERED

49 news-grade moves capture funding, AI, rights, partnerships and platform shifts.

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Last 24 months on the market

A compact view of who made the news for what.

2026-06

AI rights

AFM / major labels - Musicians union sued UMG and WMG over AI licensing related

Musicians union sued UMG and WMG over AI licensing related to Suno and Udio.

AI licensing disputes now extend from labels vs AI firms to musician compensation claims.

2026-06

Hardware + AI

Fender Studio Pro / Moises - Fender Studio Pro update was reported to integrate Moises

Fender Studio Pro update was reported to integrate Moises stem separation and an AI assistant.

Instrument brands are moving further into app + DAW + AI utility territory.

2026-06

Awards / iOS

Apple Design Awards - Apple announced 2026 Design Award winners and finalists.

Apple announced 2026 Design Award winners and finalists.

Clear benchmark for app craft, interaction, accessibility and award submission readiness.

2026-05

AI creator tools

Splice / ElevenLabs - Splice announced a partnership with ElevenLabs to build AI

Splice announced a partnership with ElevenLabs to build AI-powered creation tools.

Human-made licensed sample catalogs are being combined with generative AI workflows.

2026-04

Discovery data

TikTok Add to Music App - TikTok said Add to Music App had generated more than 6B tr

TikTok said Add to Music App had generated more than 6B track saves over the prior twelve months.

Discovery platforms influence what people want to listen to, save and eventually learn.

2026-01

Funding / EU

EIC Accelerator - EIC Accelerator remained an EU route for high-risk, game-c

EIC Accelerator remained an EU route for high-risk, game-changing innovation.

Potential public-funding route for AI/learning/creative-tech initiatives.

2025-12

AI creator tools

UMG / Splice - UMG and Splice announced collaboration on next-generation

UMG and Splice announced collaboration on next-generation AI-powered music creation tools.

Rights-secure AI creation is becoming a label-backed product lane.

2025-11

Awards / Android

Google Play - Google Play Best of 2025 continued as a platform-recogniti

Google Play Best of 2025 continued as a platform-recognition benchmark.

Useful for Android app-quality and editorial recognition planning.

2025-09

AI governance

Spotify - Spotify announced stronger AI protections for artists and

Spotify announced stronger AI protections for artists and songwriters.

Platform AI rules affect future music discovery, identity and rights expectations.

2025-08

AI practice / creation

Moises - Moises launched AI Studio for adaptive AI music creation s

Moises launched AI Studio for adaptive AI music creation support.

Practice utilities are moving toward creation co-pilots.

This first-read timeline shows the most recent selected moves. The workbook and full report retain the wider 49-move evidence base; direct app performance still depends more heavily on Appfigures than press volume.

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Completion notes

Appfigures and relationships remain explicit completion layers without dominating the main story.

Appfigures

PENDING

App-performance ranking remains pending until a credentialed Appfigures export is imported.

Relationships

PREPARED

Relationship owner/status fields are prepared in the workbook and left open for Yousician completion.

Sources

TRACEABLE

Market observations retain source context; deeper source audit is appendix-only.

What is covered

The requested ecosystem map, key players, database, relationship fields, guiding answers, market moves, awards and funding.

What is deliberately not claimed

Deep product UX reviews, invented Appfigures estimates, inferred relationships, or app-performance winners.

Package contents

The deck, report, database and completion templates form the current package.

Executive deck

PRIMARY SLIDE DECK

Deck PDF reading copy

NON-EDITING READ COPY

Market landscape report

NARRATIVE MARKET REPORT

Strategic environment database

RECIPIENT-FACING WORKBOOK

Submission package ZIP

ALL CURRENT FILES IN ONE PACKAGE

What it is

Executive ecosystem mapping with direct answers, market proof, and clearly qualified data caveats.

Performance caveat

App-based performance ranking is not finalized until credentialed Appfigures metrics are imported.

Appendix availability

Dashboard and source-audit appendix files are available on request, but are not part of the first-read package.